

three rough divisions under which the extensions created for Firefox are classified. Let's take a look at each of them.

► Add-ons

Add-ons are extensions that are generally expected to add some new functionality to your browser, that may include (but is in no way limited to) new key bindings (keyboard shortcuts) and new menu items. If you've added an element that wasn't present before (note the use of the word 'adding' instead of 'replacing') it's called an add-on. They're segregated into sub-categories, viz. SDK-based (or Jetpack) add-ons and non-SDK add-ons.

► Plug-ins

Plug-ins are the kind of extensions that try to modify the behaviour of the native Firefox code and thereby the behaviour of the browser. Maybe you developed a new way to view PDF files within the browser, or discovered a technique to analyse the communication over HTTP in a new way. You could bundle either of them as an extension. Essentially, anything that can make Firefox overlook a piece of native code and instead perform the instructions you provide would fall under this category. Did you know: The technology that powers your browser to play Flash animation was not made by Mozilla or Google (although they're trying their hands at it), but by Adobe.

► Themes

While themes need no introduction, the degree of customisation that's on offer on Firefox is worthy of a mention. Themes are generally any extension that can change the look and feel of the browser, with the change being either miniscule or massive. With a theme, you can either just graze the surface and change things such as the browser's tone and color, or you can delve deep into the UI, and go so far as to implement a completely new interface to work with. 'Complete themes' make deep changes to the browser's UI and behaviour while changes in 'regular themes' are simply changes to the appearance.



Yup, still Firefox, in Vimperator's interpretation